Chapter 6

Temperamental Tides

The first week of October 1947 found the Pakistani Government sending Dr Muhammad Din Taseer and Shaikh Sadiq Hasan to convince Sheikh Abdullah to support Jammu and Kashmir's accession to Pakistan. The Pakistanis were worried that the Maharaja had signed a deal with Abdullah and accession to India was on the cards. Abdullah did not strike a deal with them. He saw no role for himself in a Kashmir which was in Pakistan. Shortly thereafter, Abdullah flew to Delhi on 14 October, and stayed with Nehru.[1]

Other Pakistani agent provocateurs like Gilgit-born K. H. Khurshid, who was the Private Secretary to Jinnah, was also in Srinagar plotting against the Maharaja. As we have seen, mobilisation of the Pashtun tribesmen or *Kabailis* took place under the joint leadership of NWFP Chief Minister, Abdul Qayyum Khan and the Pir of Manki Sharif. Mian Iftikharuddin was the Pakistani puppet master controlling the actions of Sardar Muhammad Ibrahim Khan in Murree.

The tentacles of the Pakistani political machinery extended to the Kashmiri press corps as well. By 7 October 1947, the Maharaja introduced press censorship in the state and ordered the newspaper *Kashmir Times* to stop publishing any news on the state's accession. In protest, the newspaper suspended publication altogether. *Kashmir Times* was owned and published by Abdul Rahman Mittha in Srinagar, who was a fervent advocate of the state's accession to Pakistan. Since he was not a resident of the state, Mittha